01 / THE PURPOSE

A film is not finished when it renders.

Behind the scenes of Conscious Compute. A practical guide to keeping judgment in AI work.

"A good teacher can change the course of someone's life."

"A great teacher can change the course of an entire civilization."

That is the ambition behind Dharmic Data. This guide examines one small attempt to put it into practice.

Jai won an NVIDIA hackathon with friends. Their concept was a supportive call from your future self, using AI to help someone keep going. The prize supplied a Dell GB10 computer and expanded his means to build. Teaching and care had been part of his work for years.

His proposed school would pay a generation to become builders, owners and stewards of their communities' AI future. Conscious Compute is its workshop series. The school remains a proposal. Learner payments and ownership arrangements are not established outcomes.

To explain the idea, we attempted a fifteen-second film. The assignment grew into a sixty-second founder story, a thirty-second version and a fifteen-second expression of the same promise. We used existing computers and AI tools. We produced many files and still lost the story.

Jai rejected the films. Later revisions recovered parts of the intended meaning, but the current campaign remains unaccepted.

This guide explains what we learned about choosing a task, checking a model and knowing when to stop. You can use the same process when making something that another person must understand or trust.

This is a production case study, not an accepted campaign or a demonstrated educational outcome. Founder history is Jai's account.

02 / THE MEANING

A correct sentence can tell the wrong story

Our early account connected an award, new tools and a school. Each item was relevant. The implied cause was wrong.

One review prompt said that the win and tools explained why Jai cared. His account says that care and teaching came first. They explain the invention. Winning expanded what he could do next.

We also replaced the national ambition with a general invitation to mentored learning. That sounded friendly and was easier to illustrate with classroom footage. It reduced the institution to a workshop offer. Jai wanted people to acquire a stake in the AI systems their communities depend on.

The distinction changed what we needed to preserve.

Question	Our answer for this project
What is the person trying to make possible?	Jai wants a generation to help shape and steward community AI.
What makes his starting point distinctive?	He and his friends imagined a caring future-self call and won the means to keep building.
What must remain true?	His teaching and care preceded the prize. The school is proposed.
What can change during production?	We can change the treatment and sequence while preserving the meaning and explicit creative requirements.

The musical opening and civilizational memory were also purposeful requests. We treated them as items to include, then sometimes removed them to simplify the edit. Neither approach ensured that the audience felt a connection between the past and a shared future.

For your own project, write the intended change in one sentence before asking an agent to work. Keep the facts that must remain true beside it. When a critic suggests a repair, check both before delegating the change.

03 / THE EXPERIMENT

Test a cause you can change

We used Astra in Codex to coordinate the work. A cached F5 speech model on the M5 generated authorized voice candidates. Cached Whisper transcription helped us inspect words. Gemini supplied audiovisual criticism when its review requests succeeded.

These jobs required different evidence. A transcript could help detect an omitted word. It could not tell us that the voice sounded like Jai or moved a listener.

One local voice experiment made that distinction useful. Earlier candidates repeatedly contained an unwanted "However." Increasing the generation steps did not remove it. We then changed the reference audio and matching transcript to a clean 6.7-second passage from Jai's own teaching recording.

The following seven takes contained no "However" in their transcription checks. Some other word differences remained, and voice likeness was still unaccepted. The result supported a narrow decision about the reference material. It did not establish that the entire voice system was solved.

That seven-take batch used 27.284 seconds of recorded synthesis time. It used existing cached models, with no new API call or model download for that batch. The film version containing those takes was later rejected for its story. A useful technical result can survive inside an unsuccessful creative attempt.

For your own experiment, record the observed problem and one possible cause. Specify what you will change and what will remain fixed. Set a small attempt limit before starting. Save the unsuccessful result as well as the new one.

Choose a larger or different model when you need a capability the current method cannot provide. Repeated generation of the same unsuitable answer is insufficient evidence that more attempts will help.

ONE QUESTION	ONE CHANGE	A RECORDED DECISION
What might be causing the defect?	Change one input and keep the rest fixed.	Keep, revise, stop, or ask for help.

04 / THE REVIEW

Ask what arrived before explaining what you meant

An early reviewer was given the intended founder story in its instructions, then asked what it understood after viewing. A fluent summary could repeat our prompt without demonstrating that the film communicated the idea.

We later separated the review into two exchanges.

In the first, Gemini received the exact sixty-second file with neutral instructions. We withheld the script and mission. The reviewer understood a future-self invention and a proposed paid community school. It also reported that the book passage interrupted the film's momentum and that some later music competed with the voice.

In the second, we supplied the brief. The reviewer distinguished what it had understood from the film from context it learned afterward.

We still had to judge the criticism. The book was a captured part of Jai's literature project. Calling it a generic asset was incomplete, but knowing its origin did not prove that its role was clear on screen. We shortened the passage and returned briefly to Jai before showing the open page.

The reviewer also described a separate synthesizer layer that the inspected music source did not contain. We retained the listening concern and tested a restrained reduction in low frequencies. We did not adopt its description of the instrumentation as fact.

The revised film then needed its own review. The attempt failed with an internal error. A successful critique of the earlier version could not approve the changed one.

Use this sequence in your work. First ask what the reader or viewer understood. Then disclose the intended meaning. Record which criticism you accept, modify or reject, with a reason. A reviewer should help you judge the work without taking ownership of your purpose.

05 / THE ACCOUNTING

Fast generation does not tell you the cost of a result

One revised sixty-second film took 2.402 seconds of audio processing and 31.392 seconds of picture rendering. Those measurements are useful when planning machine capacity. They exclude the time spent finding sources, reasoning about the story and reviewing unsuccessful versions.

The wider record shows why that distinction is necessary.

Recorded scope	Measurement	What it does not establish
Seven local voice candidates in one earlier experiment	Synthesis took 27.284 seconds.	It is not the total voice-development time or a likeness approval.
The revised sixty-second candidate	Audio took 2.402 seconds and picture rendering took 31.392 seconds.	It is not the production time for the campaign.
One later Gemini review window	Seven UI requests produced two usable replies and five terminal failures.	These counts do not measure global reliability or prove that all seven requests ran inference.
One recorded goal checkpoint	The tool reported 4,880,434 tokens and 18,331 seconds, about 5.1 hours.	These are recorded goal counters, not a billing statement or final campaign totals.

The audio process's peak memory and the renderer's peak memory were recorded separately. Adding separate peaks would not establish the computers' simultaneous memory use. Electricity consumption and total monetary cost were not measured.

The voice experiment and later render used bounded work on existing Macs. The GB10 was part of Jai's available means and story, but these measurements do not prove a distributed GB10 performance advantage.

For your own project, record the work's purpose beside its resource use. Count unsuccessful attempts and review time when observed. Keep machine execution, model usage and human decisions distinct. Treat unknown cost as unknown. Decide whether another run can answer a specific question before spending the time.

06 / YOUR NEXT PROJECT

Your next useful attempt

Choose one task that helps someone do work they care about. Keep it small enough that a person can inspect the result. Before starting, fill in this short record.

Write this down	Your answer
Who will use the result, and what should become possible for them?	
Which facts or commitments must remain true?	
What exact output will you review?	
What can a technical check establish?	
What must a person read, watch, hear or try?	
What would justify another attempt, and when will you stop?	
Who can accept the result, and how will that decision be recorded?	

Keep these states separate. A file can pass technical checks before anyone reviews it. A review can be requested and fail. A person can review a file without accepting it. A file can be copied to another computer without being posted to the team.

We copied files to the M5 while the Buzz post remained blocked. Copying, posting and playback are different results.

The campaign remains unaccepted. No application was submitted.

Dharmic Data's bet is that people should have paid, protected time to develop judgment through work with others. A mentor helps them decide what to try and understand what happened. People remain responsible for accepting the result.

Keep the work. Keep the evidence. Make the decision explicit.

Continue learning at maven.com/a-plus. Explore the school at dharmicdata.org.